



GEORGIA EDGE

Now Make Georgia Home to America's Next Generation of High-Growth Companies.

Entrepreneur-Driven Georgia Ecosystem | Powered by ATDC

A statewide operating model for the innovation economy.

THE GAP

Georgia Has the Research Engine.

The issue is not whether Georgia can create innovation – it is whether Georgia can **convert** it.

8th

University R&D

Moved from 12th – top-tier research output nationally

34th

VC Growth

Trailing peer states in five-year venture capital growth

38th

R&D Value-Added

Research intensity not translating fast enough into economic value

44th

Formation Conversion

Strong business applications; weak conversion into operating businesses

⚠ Georgia has built the research engine. Now it needs the operating model that turns research, talent and ideas into companies, jobs and economic impact.

Georgia Founders Are Already Competitive.

The talent is not waiting for permission. It is already competing nationally – showing up in elite startup channels like YC.

The Reality

Georgia Tech founders already placing in elite national programs

The Gap

Too many are scaling *outside* Georgia – capital, customers and coaching flow elsewhere

The Fix

EDGE gives them the ecosystem to **win at home** – capital + customers + coaching + talent + commercialization



But There Is a Problem.

Georgia's innovation assets are still too fragmented to perform as one system.



Founders

Competing without a unified support system



Research

Strong output, low commercialization rate



Capital

Trailing peer states in VC growth and deployment



Corporations

Disconnected from early-stage pipeline



Talent

World-class – often leaves the state to scale



Regions

Active locally – not yet operating as one system

 **Assets exist. The coordination layer is missing.**



Georgia Does Not Lack Assets. Georgia Lacks Coordination.

"True coordination is lacking."

BCG's Atlanta entrepreneurship analysis: the region has high-quality talent, research and entrepreneurial energy – but needs **deeper coordination** across institutions and stakeholders to unlock the ecosystem flywheel.

Source: BCG, *Leveling Up: Unlocking Entrepreneurship Growth Potential for Atlanta*

☐ That is the job EDGE is designed to do – statewide.

ATDC Proved the Capability.

Georgia already has a platform founders trust — and that can scale statewide. The first university-led incubator in the U.S.

45+

Years of Founder Support

America's longest-running university incubator

\$7.9B+

Capital Raised

Lifetime capital raised by ATDC portfolio and graduate companies

15,585

Jobs Created

By active and graduate ATDC companies

315

Entrepreneurs Educated

ATDC Educate members in 2025

📄 Georgia's next chapter requires more than an incubator — it requires a **statewide operating model** designed for the speed, scale and coordination of today's innovation economy.

The Model Must Evolve.

From a successful incubator to a statewide innovation operating system.

TODAY

Great programs, uneven access. Regional activity exists – but no unified cadence, playbook or scorecard.

EDGE

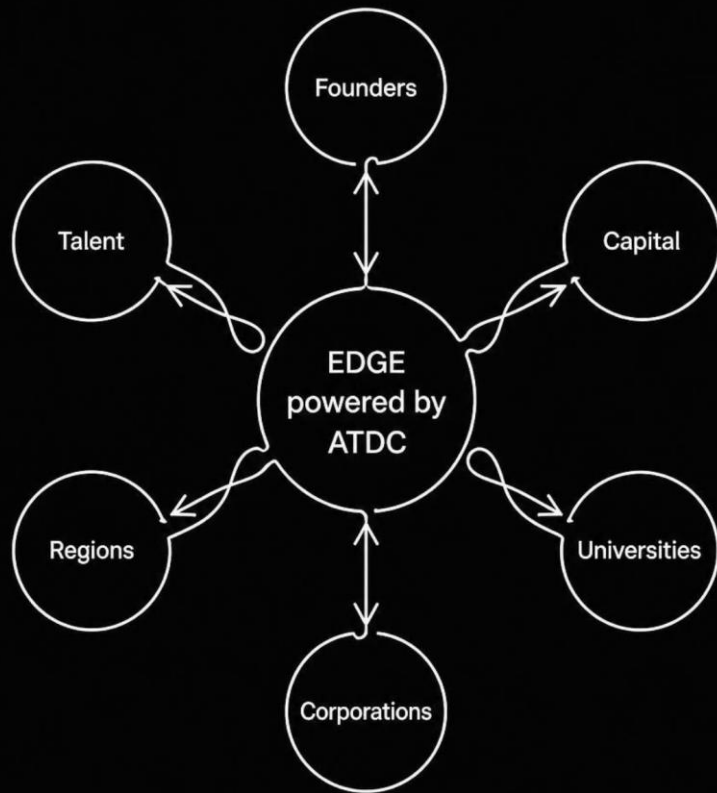
One operating model statewide. A connected system aligning regions, universities, corporations, investors, talent and founders around measurable company creation.



What got Georgia here will not get Georgia to national innovation leadership.

Georgia EDGE

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One Playbook

Shared methodology across every region and institution

One Cadence

Synchronized rhythm of programs, funding cycles and milestones

One Scorecard

Unified metrics – companies created, jobs, capital, commercialization

Statewide Alignment

Every stakeholder rowing in the same direction

EDGE Only Works If the Governor Makes It a Statewide Priority.

This is a leadership problem before it is a program problem.

1

Set the Vision

Make innovation-driven company creation a pillar of Georgia's economic leadership

2

Align the Ecosystem

Unite universities, technical colleges, CTAE, regions, entrepreneurs, investors, corporations and state partners through one model

3

Measure the Outcomes

Track companies created, high-wage jobs, per-capita income, capital attracted and research commercialized

📌 Leadership turns Georgia's assets into national advantage.



3 Major Initiatives to Activate EDGE



Socialize Rigorous Risk-Mitigating Programming

Deploy proven, structured programming statewide that reduces founder risk, increases survival rates, and builds investor confidence across Georgia's ecosystem.



Implement an Agentic Platform for Ecosystem Connectivity

Build an AI-powered platform that intelligently connects companies, investors, research institutions and universities, TCSG, and mentors – removing friction and accelerating collaboration at scale.



Create a Public/Private Lead Investment Fund

Establish a dedicated fund to provide lead investment for investable and investment-ready companies, catalyzing private capital and keeping high-growth companies anchored in Georgia.

Georgia Can Become America's Entrepreneurial Engine.

→ Georgia Has the Assets

Research, talent, corporations, regions and capital – already best-in-class

→ ATDC Proved the Capability

A trusted, 45-year platform with measurable founder outcomes at scale

→ EDGE Aligns the System

One operating model. One scorecard. Statewide innovation leadership.

**The opportunity is clear.
The capability exists. The
moment requires action.**



What's Plan "B" ?